- Growth is slower than it could be and inequality higher than it ought to be.

## II. Reforms

In the times of globalising world being in sync with the time and contemporary world will be necessary. There will be requirement of speedier concensus on the fronts of ‘economic reforms’. If the required kind of ‘reforms’ are effected at the ‘right’ times, outcomes may be glorious and historic –

- Vast improvements in infrastructure, education, as well as in business regulation and labour laws.
- As fewer workers depend on agriculture, larger holdings and more investment in capital and technology create a much healthier agricultural sector, with significant rural entrepreneurship surrounding activities like horticulture, dairy products, and meat.
- The manufacturing sector becomes a training ground for workers, absorbing more students with a middle or high school education.
- India moves into niches vacated by China such as semi-skilled manufacturing, even while enhancing its advantage in skilled manufacturing and services.
- India experiences faster and more equitable growth.
- Social frictions are minimized as both agriculture and manufacturing create better livelihoods.

## III. Decline

Suppose India fails or lags in the process of putting the ‘required set of things’ in place, so that it can strengthen its position to garner higher demographic dividend – i.e. no improvement in infrastructure, education, or institutions . Just visualise the resulting ugly scenarios –

- As fewer jobs are created outside of agriculture, more people stay in agriculture, increasing the pressure on land and lowering incomes. Small agricultural plots do not provide enough income, nor can they be leased out.